

stand up for even that: they'll swear that it's pure stereo speakers that deliver stereo sound best. In fact, some audiophiles swear that stereo sound is best listened to using quality headphones.

Whatever the case, our point stands that if it's stereo music (DVD Audio being an exception, since it's been recorded through more than two channels) you're going to listen to, with the occasional game thrown in, you're better off with 2.1 speakers—not to mention that if you're on a budget, 2.1 would naturally be the way to go.

5.1, like we said, is for movies—DVD movies in particular—and games. It's all about immersion and the surround experience. DVD movies that use standards such as DTS and Dolby Pro Logic IIx need a 5.1 system for accurate sound reproduction. And as any gamer will tell you, 2.1 systems just don't cut it—there's almost no realism if you're talking about today's immersive games!

If you're not really an audiophile and would like to be immersed in music, then again, 5.1 is the way to go. You sit in the middle of the room and the sound seems to fill the room. That's not accurate reproduction, like we said, but some folks like it that way—it's a little bit like using the graphic equaliser: you add and subtract from the sound, making it less faithful to the original, but if that's the way you like it—go ahead with 5.1!

We proceed to talk about the four best 2.1 speaker sets from our speaker shootout in the May 2006 issue of *Digit*. These are (not in any particular order) the Altec Lansing FX-6021 and MX-5021, and the Logitech X-230 and Z-2300. These are the four sets you should be looking for.

1.2.1 Speaker Sets (2.1)

Remote Controls

Both the Altec Lansing models come with wired control pods as well as wireless remote controls. There are volume, bass and treble controls on both the wired and wireless units. The Logitech Z-2300 has a wired control pod with a large volume dial and a smaller bass dial.